

Cage Games Set For Mexicans, Former Miners

A two-game basketball series May 1-2, between the Mexican Olympic team and a team comprised mostly of former University of Texas at El Paso players, was announced Saturday in the El Paso office of Congressman Richard C. White (D-El Paso).

The first game is to be played in Juarez at Monumental Bull Ring with the second set for El Paso County Coliseum.

The announcement came at a conference called by White and Endicott Peabody, assistant director of the Office of Emergency Planning in Washington.

Purpose of the conference was to explain the part the basketball games and sports, in general, would play in the United States-Mexico border relations program to a group of El Pasoans, prominent in sports, and enlist their help in promoting the program.

At present there is some discussion as to what the team from this area will be called. At the conference, the name Texas Western All Stars was discussed. But at a later luncheon meeting, the possibilities of inviting some players from Juarez and some former New Mexico State University players to join the team and changing the name to Rio Grande All Stars were discussed.

Saul Kleinfeld, coach of the Union Furniture team, was selected to promote the basketball games. Most of the former U.T. El Paso players who will comprise the majority of the team have been playing with the Union Furniture squad.

The former Miners on the Union team are Bobby Joe Hill, Harry Flournoy, Charley Banks, Bobby Dibler and Bobby Leslie. Also expected to join the team are Willie Worsley and Willie Cager. And Kleinfeld said there was a possibility that Nolan Richardson and Orsten Artis would return to El Paso long enough to play in the games.

The group of El Pasoans, including Dr. Joseph M. Ray, George McCarty, Jim Bowden, Orba Lee Malone, John McFall, Andy Cohen, City Alderman Sal Berroterran and John Phelan, will form a committee to help with preparations for the game.

Although he was unable to be present for the conference, Kleinfeld said Mike Brumblelow was contacted later and had accepted the chairmanship of the committee with Phelan serving as assistant chairman.

Kleinfeld said County Judge Colbert Coldwell was also added to the committee and U.T. El Paso sports information director Eddie Mullens, in Detroit with the Miner track team Saturday, would be asked to join the committee.

Kleinfeld said plans are being made to invite several professional basketball stars to El Paso to conduct a cage clinic for youngsters on both sides of the border in conjunction with the games.

Accompanying Peabody, former governor of Massachusetts, to El Paso for the conference was David Carrasco, sports attache to the U.S. Embassy in Mexico City.

Peabody and Carrasco met later Saturday with Juarez Mayor Armando Gonzalez Soto to discuss plans for the games.